



CBS
care based safety

Brand Guidelines



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Brand Overview

Care-Based Safety (CBS) is a community-rooted organisation working to replace punishment-based responses with care-centred approaches to safety. Grounded in abolitionist principles and led by the belief that safety is relational, CBS builds and advocates for non-police crisis response, prevention-first systems, and community-led solutions.

CBS communicates with warmth, clarity, and conviction. Our voice is compassionate yet firm, future-oriented yet grounded in real community needs. Through accessible language, relational imagery, and people-first storytelling, we demonstrate that care-based safety is not only possible, but practical and effective.

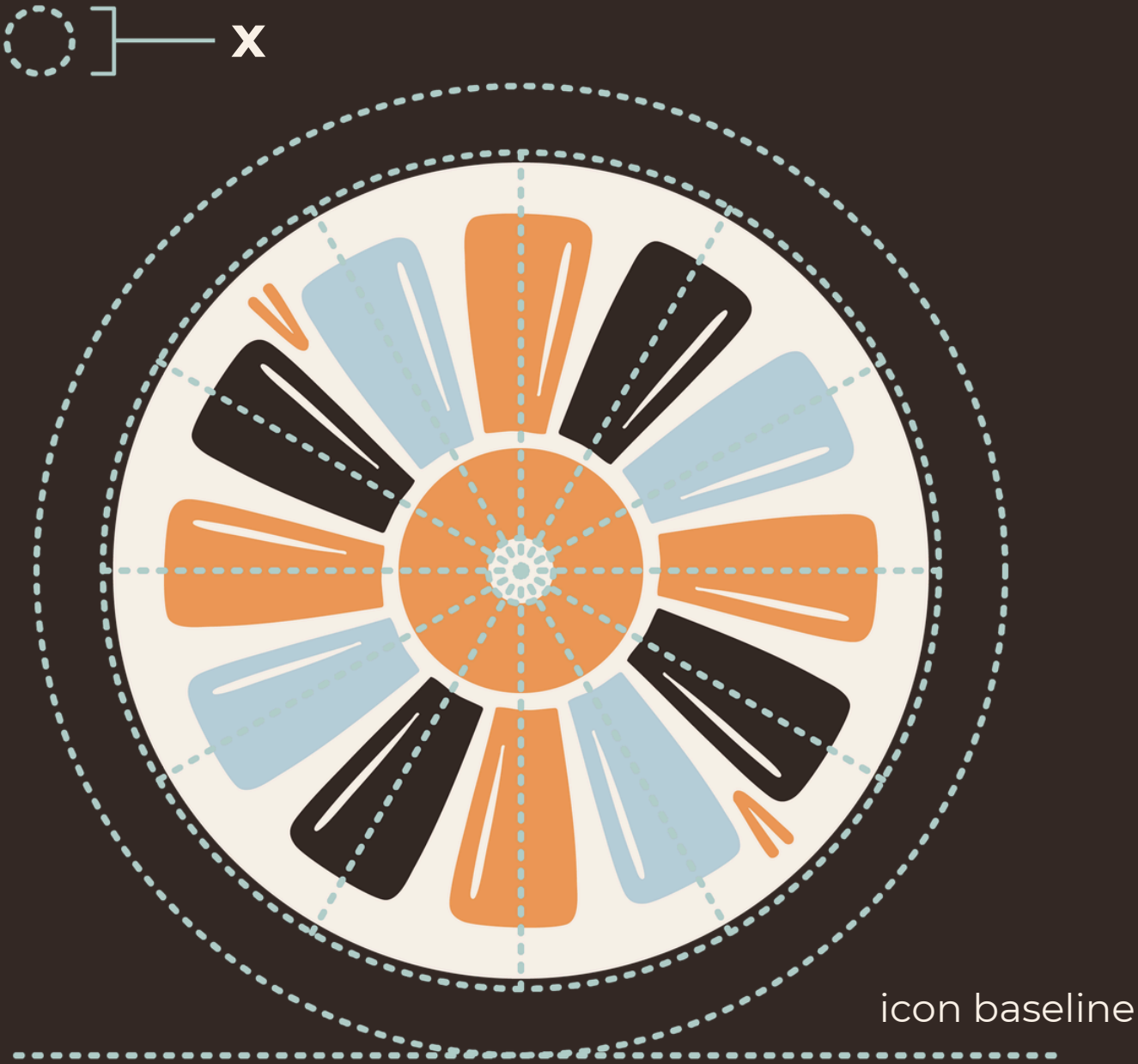
Logo: concept



The CBS symbol is designed to evoke **warmth, ease, and a sense of breathing room**. Its radiating circular form communicates safety and care without relying on traditional policing symbols. Instead, the **expanding beams** create a feeling of openness and shared energy, reflecting the belief that safety grows from community rather than enforcement. At the centre sits a single point representing community as the core of safety, from which **care and support radiate outward**. The hand-drawn, expressive strokes introduce humanity, reflecting lived experience.

The symbol also carries layered visual meanings. The radiating forms can be read as **sunbeams, petals, or ribbons**, allowing the mark to reference warmth, growth, and celebration simultaneously. As a flower, it suggests **roots, nature, and community flourishing together**; as beams, it conveys **light and guidance**; and as ribbons, it hints at **mutual support and shared celebration**. Beneath the organic strokes lies a circular geometry that keeps the symbol balanced and grounded, representing the structure and principles that guide care-based safety. This combination of expressive marks and geometric order reflects CBS's approach: compassion and creativity working within thoughtful frameworks to create collective safety, growth, and transformation.

Logo: construction



The CBS logo is built using a **circular grid system** to ensure balance and visual harmony.

The centre circle of the symbol is the base measurement.

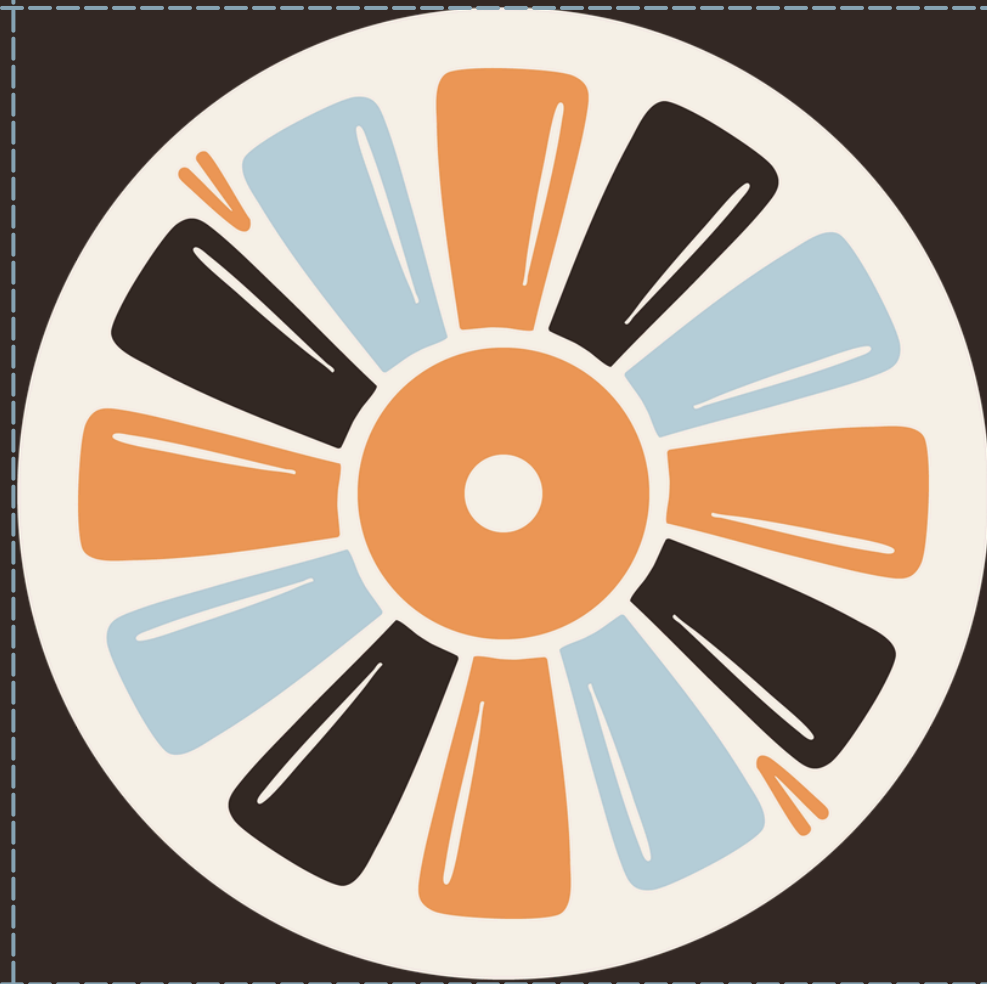
x = centre circle diameter

All proportions scale from this unit.

Element	size
Centre circle	1X
Outer symbol diameter	3.75X
Ray extension length	3X
Full outer circle	12.5X
Ray count	16 radial segments

Each ray is evenly distributed across the 360° circle, creating a balanced sunburst form.

Logo: clearspace



The CBS logo requires consistent clear space to maintain visibility and impact.

The safe area is defined using the base unit X. This is measured from the outer edge of the symbol.

Always maintain this spacing from:

- page edges
- text blocks
- photography
- graphics
- other logos



Logo:
variations



CBS
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This is the **dark** version of the logo, designed for use on dark backgrounds to ensure clarity, contrast, and accessibility.



CBS
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This is the **light** version of the logo, designed for use on dark backgrounds to ensure clarity, contrast, and accessibility.

Logo: variations



This is the **horizontal** version of the logo, to be used when space allows for a wider format or where a stacked version would feel constrained.



This is the **shorthand** version of the logo, to be used in smaller spaces or where a simplified brand mark is more practical while still maintaining clear recognition.

Palette

Hex Code #332824	CMYK 0,22,29,80	RGB 51,40,36
Hex Code #F9F0E6	CMYK 0,4,8,2	RGB 249,240,230
Hex Code #F4F1E9	CMYK 25,9,0,30	RGB 134,163,179
Hex Code #F4F1E9	CMYK 15,0,1,18	RGB 177,209,206
Hex Code #F4F1E9	CMYK 0,21,40,2	RGB 249,197,149

Typography

The typography helps bring the voice to life, creating clear, accessible communications that feel consistent, confident, and easy to read across all touchpoints.

Font Overview

Monsterrat SemiBold

For Headers

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
Zabcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz1234
567890!@#\$%^&*()

Monsterrat Light

For Subheaders and Paragraphs

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
WXYZabcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
xyz1234567890!@#\$%^&*()

Imagery & Photography

- **Community-rooted and relational:** real people in genuine moments of connection, collaboration, and care rather than posed or institutional scenes (stock images may be used if they fit this narrative).
- **Natural and unpolished:** soft natural lighting, candid compositions, minimal staging, avoiding glossy or corporate aesthetics.
- **Warm and emotionally grounded:** imagery that conveys ease, safety, deep breaths, and being seen and held by community.
- **Dignified and agency-centered:** subjects portrayed with strength and autonomy, never as victims or passive recipients of support.
- **Local and place-based:** recognizable environments from Washtenaw County, reinforcing trust and community ownership.



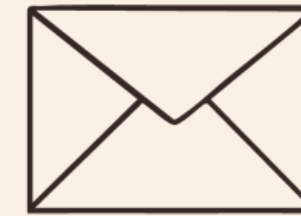
Graphics

- **Soft, rounded character illustrations** that feel approachable, human, and grounded in care.
- **Muted, earthy colour palette with warm accents** to reflect safety and stability.
- **Minimal linework and flat forms** to keep visuals calm, clear, and accessible.
- **Relational scenes that centre connection,** support, and community over authority.
- **Expressive but gentle body language** and facial features that convey empathy and trust.



Iconography

The iconography is simple, purposeful, and easy to understand, supporting the communications with consistency while reinforcing a care-centred approach.



Brand Personality

CBS's voice should consistently feel:

- **Abolitionist**: clear, principled, values-driven
 - **Compassionate**: human, warm, grounded in care
 - **Imaginative**: future-oriented, hopeful, expansive
 - **Co-created**: community-led, collective, relational
 - **Trustworthy**: steady, consistent, accountable
-

How we sound:

- **Professional and modern**
- **Warm, caring, and trauma-informed**
- **Clear and grounded**
- **Calm but firm**
- **Relational, not institutional**

What Our Tone Is **Not**:

- **Punitive or shaming**
- **Academic or inaccessible**
- **Neutral about harm or injustice**
- **Sensationalist or alarmist**
- **Cold, bureaucratic, or carceral**

Tone of Voice

CBS’s tone of voice is warm, clear, and grounded in care.

Primary Audience: Community & Service Users

- Speak directly, respectfully, and accessibly
- Use plain language (6th-grade reading level)
- Avoid jargon or academic framing
- Lead with care, agency, and dignity

Example:

You deserve care, not punishment. In moments of crisis, we’re here to walk alongside you with compassion, respect for your choices, and the support of community.

Secondary Audience: Funders, Partners, Activists

- Be values-clear and strategic
- Emphasize impact, sustainability, and community trust
- Connect abolitionist principles to measurable outcomes

Example:

Care-based safety works. It produces stronger outcomes, builds lasting resilience, and offers a sustainable alternative to punitive systems.

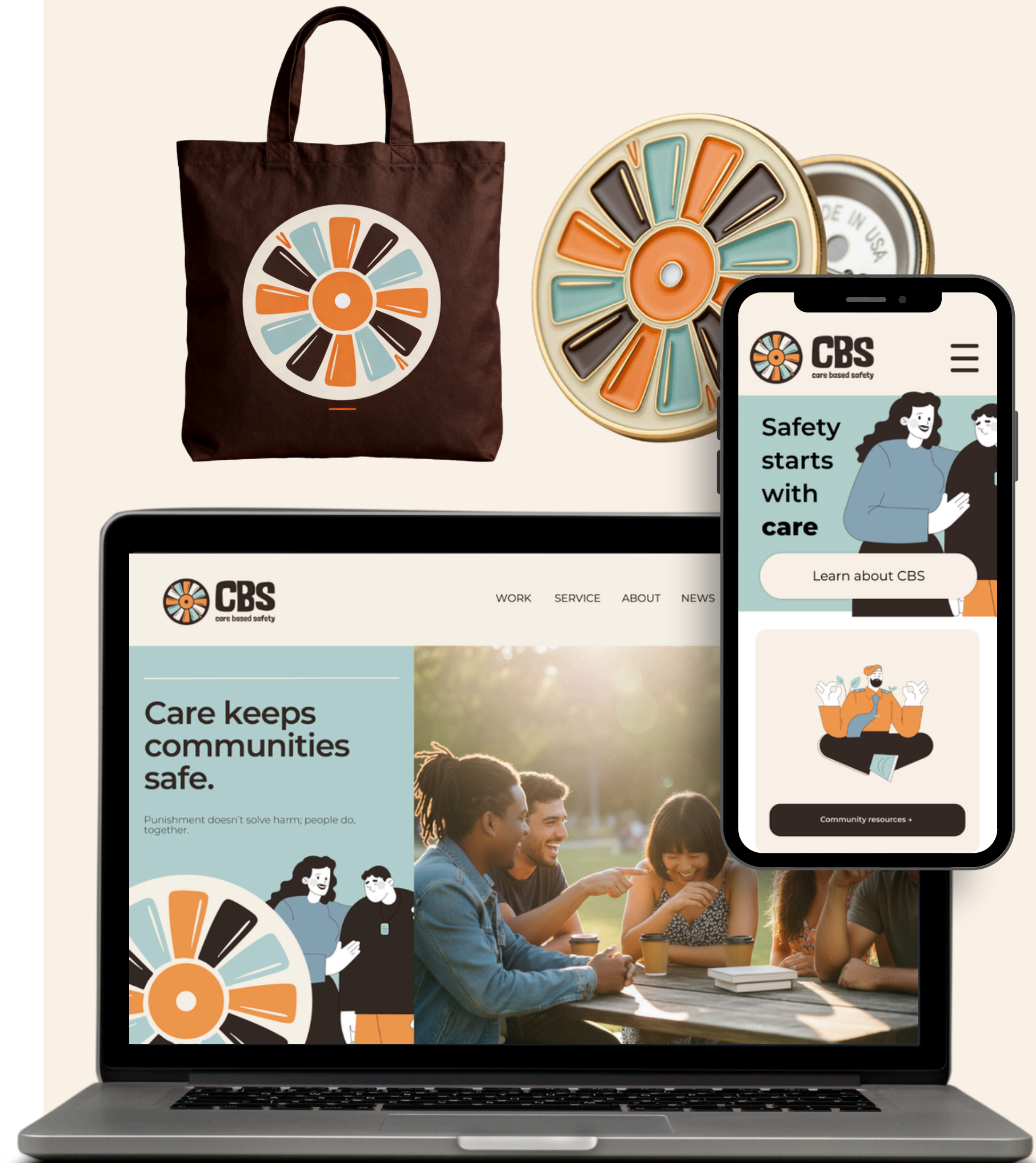
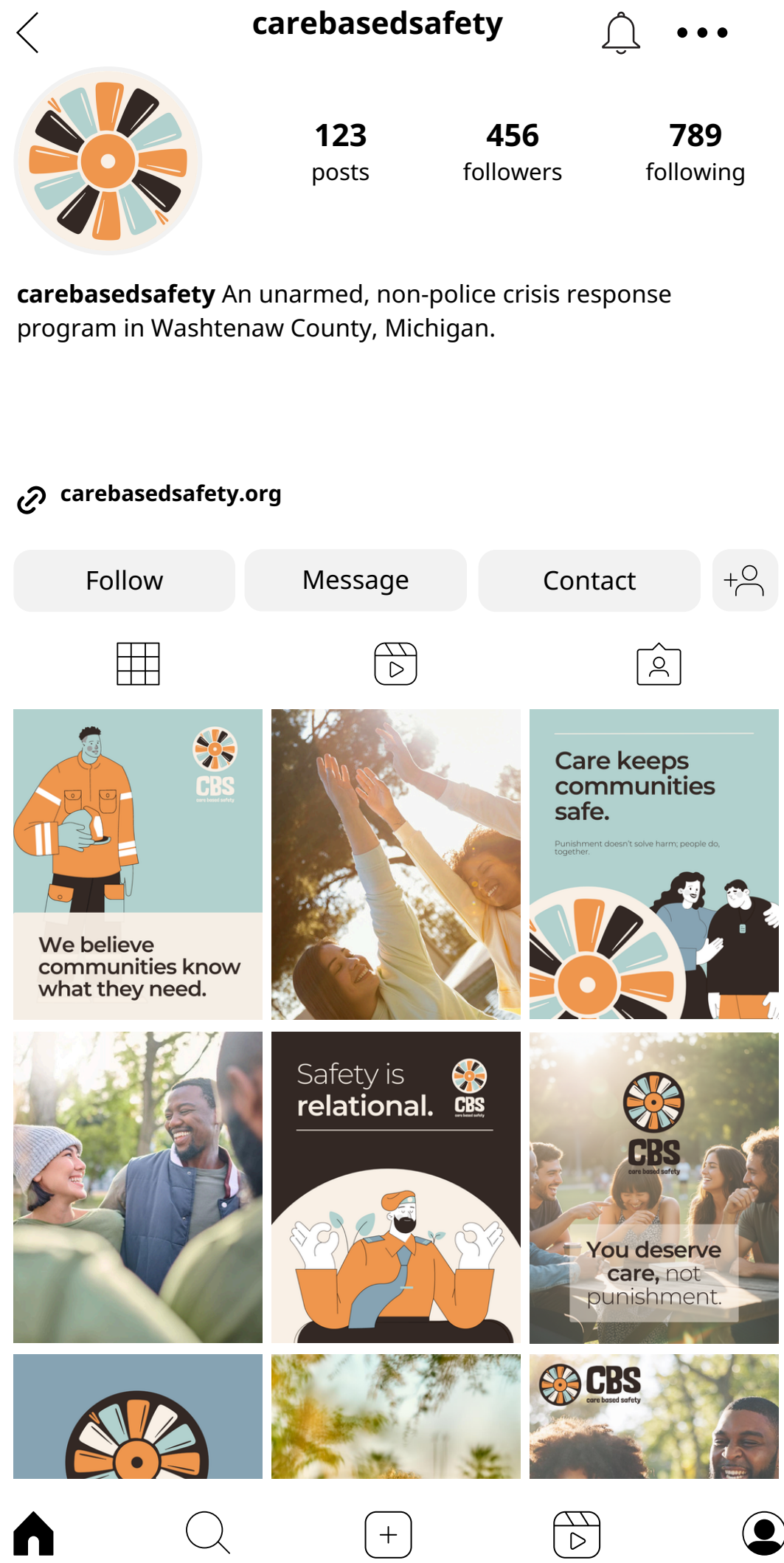
Stretch Audiences: Government & Skeptical Public

- Lead with outcomes, not provocation
- Avoid reactionary language
- Emphasize public health, prevention, and cost-effectiveness
- Frame care as common sense, not ideology

Example:

Non-police crisis response strengthens public safety by intervening early and connecting people to appropriate support. When communities invest in non-police crisis response, they lower system strain and improve long-term safety outcomes.

Brand Applications



Safety begins with **care.**

Brand identity and visual system created by Studio KAIL

